

Yu Rain Kan

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ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE	Indiana University, Kelley School of Business Assistant Professor of Information Systems	2024 -
EDUCATION	University of Washington, Michael G. Foster School of Business Ph.D. in Business Administration, Information Systems	2019–2024
	Georgia Institute of Technology, Industrial and Systems Engineering (ISyE) Master of Science in Analytics	2018-2019
	Peking University, School of Foreign Language Bachelor of Linguistic in German	2014-2018
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Research Focus AI, Digital Marketing, E-commerce Methodology Machine Learning, Econometrics, Experimental Design, Causal Inference, Economic Theories	
RESEARCH	• “‘Be the Buyer’ – Leveraging the Wisdom of the Crowd in E-Commerce Operations” Leela Nageswaran*, Yu (Rain) Kan*, Uttara M. Ananthakrishnan*.¹ <i>Management Science</i> (2025) JFIG Best Paper Competition - Finalist, INFORMS • “One Size Fits All? Informational Accessibility and Inclusivity in Online Platforms” Yu (Rain) Kan*, Ye Liu*, Uttara M. Ananthakrishnan, Yong Tan Under 2nd Round Major Revision at <i>Management Science</i> • “When Identity Is Ambiguous: Emotional Misrepresentation in Customer Care Interactions” Yu (Rain) Kan, Yifan Yu, Lin Jia, Yong Tan Under 2nd Round Major Revision at <i>MIS Quarterly</i> SMA Best Student Paper Award - Finalist, INFORMS • “Speaking to the Mind or the Heart: Examining the Motivational and Evaluative Roles of Managerial Responses” Wanxin Qiao, Yu (Rain) Kan, Yi-Chun (Chad) Ho, Zhijun Yan, Qiuju Yin. Under 2nd Round Major Revision at <i>MIS Quarterly</i> • “From Description to Intention: How Goal-Oriented Labels Drive Engagement in Online Peer Support Platforms” Yu (Rain) Kan, Lucy Yan, Jun Tan Under 1st Round Major Revision at <i>Information Systems Research</i> • “Agentic Agent, Better Agent: Evidence from Agentic AI in Telemarketing” Yu (Rain) Kan*, Mingrui (Ray) Zhang*, Wenkang Qiu, Fengwen Chen, Yong Tan Under Review at <i>Management Science</i> • “Sustaining Value Creation in Online Weightloss Platforms: A Service Ecosystem Perspective”	

¹* Indicates equal contribution.

Lucy Yan, Yu (Rain) Kan, Yong Tan

Under Review at *Production and Operations Management*

- “Configured to Care: How AI Emotional Expression Shapes User Engagement in Mental Health Support”
Yuqing Hu, Yu (Rain) Kan, Lucy Yan
Work in Progress
- “Imitation, Experimentation, and Mastery: Unpacking Learning Strategies in Generative AI Communities”
Lei Wang, Yu (Rain) Kan, Alan R. Dennis
Work in Progress

AWARDS AND HONORS	ISS Nunamaker-Chen Dissertation Award - First Place	2025
	SMA Best Student Paper Award - Finalist, INFORMS	2023
	JFIG Best Paper Competition - Finalist, INFORMS	2023
	Outstanding Research Award, Department of ISOM, University of Washington	2023
	Best Paper Award - Runner Up, CIST	2020
	Best Student Paper - Nomination, CIST	2020
	Evert McCabe Endowed Fellowship Program in Private Enterprise	2021-2022
	Bertha L. Mills Fellowship	2019-2020

CONFERENCE PAPERS	• “Agentic Agent, Better Agent: Evidence from Agentic AI in Telemarketing” Statistical Challenges in Electronic Commerce Research (SCECR) Tokyo, Japan, 2026	
	• “Who is on the Line? Examining LLM-powered Agentic AI in Telemarketing” Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST) Atlanta, GA, 2025	
	• “COVID-19 Vaccine Supply: Access and Fairness” Production and Operations Management Society (POMS) Atlanta, GA, 2025	
	• “Decoding the Language of Social Support: How Labeling Shapes Engagement in Online Peer Support Platforms” Production and Operations Management Society (POMS) Atlanta, GA, 2025	
	• “One Size Fits All? Informational Accessibility and Inclusivity in Online Platforms” International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS) Bangkok, Thailand, 2024	
	• “Chatbot in Disguise: How Non-Disclosing Agent Identity Spurs Strategic Behavior” INFORMS Social Media Analytics Best Student Paper Award Phoenix, AZ, 2023	
	• “One Size Fits All? Informational Accessibility and Inclusivity in Online Platforms” Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE) Hyderabad, India, 2023	
	• “One Size Fits All? Informational Accessibility and Inclusivity in Online Platforms” Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST) Phoenix, AZ, 2023	
	• “‘Be the Buyer’ – Leveraging the Wisdom of the Crowd in E-Commerce Operations” Manufacturing and Service Operations Management Conference Montreal Canada, 2023	
	• “Whose Idea to Learn: Atypicality Innovation and Crowdfunding Project Performance” International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS) Copenhagen, Denmark, 2022	
	• “Exploring the Long Tail: Taste Clusters and Sales Diversity on Subscription-Based Platforms” ZEW Conference on Information and Communication Technologies Mannheim, Germany, 2022	
	• “Taste Clusters, Long Tail and Sales Diversity on Subscription-Based Platforms” Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE) Austin, TX, 2021	
	• “Taste Clusters, Long Tail and Sales Diversity on Subscription-Based Platforms” Conference on Digital Experimentation @ MIT (CODE@MIT) Virtual, 2021	
	• “Taste Clusters, Long Tail and Sales Diversity on Subscription-Based Platforms” INFORMS Annual Meeting Anaheim, CA, 2021	

- “Whose Words To Believe? The Polarity Of Customer Reviews On Apparel Rental Platforms”
INFORMS Annual Meeting Indiana, 2022
- “Atypicality Innovation and Crowdfunding Project Performance”
Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST) Virtual, 2020
INFORMS Annual Meeting Virtual, 2020

ACADEMIC SERVICE **Journal Reviewer** for Management Science, Information Systems Research, MIS Quarterly, Production and Operations Management, and Journal on Computing
Session Chair for INFORMS 2024, POMS 2025
Conference Reviewer for ICIS, CIST, PACIS, IT&M, CSWIM

TEACHING EXPERIENCE **Indiana University**
 • BUS-K353: Business Analytics & Modeling Fall 2024, Fall 2025
 • BUS-S635: Special Topics in Information Systems Fall 2025

PROFICIENCIES **Skills**
 Python, R, Stata, SQL, Mathematica, Maple
Languages
 English (fluent), Chinese (native), German (fluent)